Growth Strategy Brief - Team 89

Company Name: EdVisingU AI
Date: January 23rd to February 13th, 2026

Executive Summary

Project objective:

Develop and implement a clear, differentiated brand positioning and messaging strategy for EdVisingU that communicates its value as a trusted AI-guidance and career navigation platform for students, parents, and early-career professionals — enabling increased student enrollment, stronger brand recognition, and scalable growth in 2026.

Key insights:

59% of young people believe AI threatens job prospects (Harvard Youth Poll), while 90% already use AI in academics (Forbes).

Students are using AI tools but lack structured, responsible career guidance around how AI affects degree relevance and employability

Messaging currently emphasizes credentials over outcomes.

Authority (“Dr. D,” 25 years experience) builds trust with parents, but students need clearer, outcome-driven messaging focused on employability and career security.

Strategic Direction:

Formalize EdVisingU’s position as the bridge between AI disruption and career security.

Shift messaging from features such as micro credentials and frameworks to clear outcomes such as employability, job readiness, and future proof skills.

Segment communication clearly for students, parents, and early career professionals.

Why This Matters:

Clear branding and segmented messaging will increase student trust, improve conversion rates, and position EdVisingU AI as a trusted leader in AI fluency and career strategy.

Project Scope & Approach

Target Research Question: How can EdVisingU clarify and refine its brand positioning and messaging to better communicate its unique value and attract high quality student and parent segments in a rapidly evolving AI driven education landscape?

Methodology and Sources:

- Audit and analyze current messaging by reviewing the website, programs, micro credentials, and social media to identify gaps in clarity and positioning
- Gather audience and market insights using research such as the Harvard Youth Poll on AI anxiety, Forbes data showing 90 percent AI usage among students, and Government of Canada funding toward AI and digital literacy
- Define and refine brand positioning by clarifying the value proposition, aligning messaging to specific customer segments, and connecting insights to the chosen consumer driven promotion strategy

In Scope:

- Reviewing and refining EdVisingU messaging across website, programs, and marketing materials
- Clarifying the value proposition and brand positioning
- Developing audience focused messaging recommendations for students, parents, and early career professionals

Out of Scope:

- Full visual rebranding or website redesign
- Course or curriculum changes
- Sales execution or operational restructuring

Market Landscape & Key Trends

Market Landscape & Key Trends

- Industry overview
  - It is very clear that the use of AI is widespread. It is shown from 1,100 U.S students, 90% of students use AI for academic work (Forbes 2025).
- Key market trends
  - A major conflict that students have realized is the threat that A.I can impose on their future; and so naturally, this has increased the need for a clear structured career guidance.
  - Aside from career guidance, many students around the globe don't receive proper A.I guidance. According to a study in 2023, about 36% of students receive formal guidance (Nourbakhsh 2025).
- What this means for the company
  - There is clearly a need and demand for AI guidance and career reassurance amongst students.
  - By positioning itself as a bridge between AI and students, this company can quickly become a trusted support platform.
  - Communication with customers can emphasize employability and real outcomes.

Target Customer Segments - Students

High School Students (Grades 11-12)

- High achievers targeting competitive programs (Computer Science, Business, Engineering)
- Main concern: Will AI make their chosen program obsolete before graduation?
- Need data-backed validation that their chosen program will remain relevant
- Some may be willing to pay for micro-credentials ($9.97) to gain competitive edge

Current University Students (Years 1-2)

- Already enrolled but questioning if their program will lead to employment
- Looking for ways to supplement degree with AI-relevant skills
- Value the “Professor” credibility - trust academic insiders over influencers

Target Customer Segments - Parents & Early Career

Parents of University-Bound Students

- Household income $70k+, facing $50k+ tuition costs with 54% behind on savings
- Main fear: Child graduates with debt but no job prospects
- Skeptical of university marketing; need third-party validation and expert analysis
- View $300 consulting as “insurance policy” to protect $50k investment

Recent Graduates & Early Career Professionals (Ages 21-26)

- Underemployed with degree, facing 29% drop in entry-level job postings since 2024
- Feel betrayed by traditional education system; need rapid, affordable upskilling
- $9.97 micro-credentials are impulse-buy affordable, provide immediate resume boost
- Relate to Dr. D’s first-generation student background and system navigation

Current Customer Messaging - Overview

Current Brand Positioning

- “Dr. D” - The Insider Expert: PhD academic with 25 years in post-secondary education who understands the system from the inside
- Core Promise: “Don’t just get a degree; get a future-proof roadmap”
- Tone: Urgent yet empathetic - validates anxiety about AI disruption while offering actionable guidance

What Is Working Well

- “Hybrid Degrees” concept - combining technical and human skills directly addresses market anxiety about AI automation
- Authority markers (“Dr.”, “25 years experience”) build trust with parents who need expert validation
- First-generation student narrative creates relatability and positions as advocate vs corporate advisor
- Focus on “broken pathways” and systemic problems resonates with widespread frustration

Current Customer Messaging - Gaps & Alignment

Critical Gaps in Current Messaging

- Brand Fragmentation: Multiple sub-brands (EdVisingU, Crediversity, Dr. D Learn) confuse customers and dilute messaging
- Academic Jargon: Terms like “micro-credentials,” “pedagogy,” “blockchain” alienate Gen Z students who want practical outcomes
- Process vs. Results: Current messaging focuses on features (courses, frameworks) rather than outcomes (getting hired, job security)

Segment Alignment

- Parents: Strong alignment - academic tone, risk frameworks, and professional credentials resonate
- Students: Light alignment - appreciate expertise but need punchier, platform-native content (TikTok-style, not webinars), note students don't resonate with AI generated videos they are more likely to engage with more raw content coming from peers or trusted people in industry, look at creators like @mandaround or @nate.b.jones on tiktok for reference.
- Early Career: Light alignment with first-gen student story; need more emphasis on immediate employability

Opportunities and Strategic Options

Opportunity Identification - Harshita

Key Opportunities Areas	Supporting Insights	Why these Opportunities?
● B2B AI Modernization for Postsecondary Institutions ● AI Micro-Credentials Embedded in Degree Programs ● Parent & Family Decision-Support Platform ● Customer Base Utilization & Service Activation	● Educational Institution Pain Points ○ AI use to further post-secondary initiatives ● Industry and Student Market Trends ○ Higher use of AI within Degrees and Career Growth ● Emotional Presence ○ Families require support during high-pressure times like the post-secondary shift	● AI disruption anxiety is high within the industry as students face a tougher job market ● Budget constraint & Funding reallocations impact student participation ● Governments heighten funding related to AI usage and digital transformation initiatives

Strategic Options - Harshita

Option 1: B2B Institutional AI Consulting Focus	Option 2: Scalable AI Micro-Credentials Platform	Option 3: Consumer-Driven Promotions & Segmentation
Focuses on *fewer, but higher value* contracts like with governmental agencies, SME's **Pros:** High contract value ($25K–$500K+) compared to Family contract values ($300–$1K); High revenue growth **Cons:** Longer, in-depth contracts require more time and human capital -> may have to hire more employees	Focuses on *education, do-it-yourself* AI-learning content for all customers **Pros:** takes pressure off of Founder Dr. D from consultations to growth plans as content is more self-initiated **Cons:** personalization of services decreases, potentially impacting business goals and consumer benefits	Leverage specific consumer groups to capitalize on existing opportunities with higher return **Pros:** Easily evaluated for impact based on activity and digitization; emphasizes current business goals **Cons:** higher investment into promotion for potentially small contracts

Recommendations

Chosen strategy - Consumer-Driven Promotions & Segmentation

Why: Current business goals align with supporting and innovating post-secondary student trajectories (seen through past partnerships, use of AI, and vision alignment). This consumer base can be more easily attracted due to rising AI usage in the industry.

Key Goals:

- Boosting student success in such a digital world
- More student success leads to further innovation
- Making AI and technology more approachable for students.

Key differentiators:

- To teach students about emerging technologies that are not taught in a traditional school setting
- Preparing students to adapt and understand modern technologies

How: Targeting customer base using service demos, free-trials, and promotions through universities/post-secondary institutions

Implementation Considerations

30 Days

Highlight Target Audience

Segment Consumer Base:

- Parents of Grade 11–12 students
- First-year undergrads
- Institutional innovation leads

Resources: University Publicity (University Fairs, Resource Boards); Social Media

60 Days

Campaign + Execution

Implement Consumer-facing initiatives:

- Social media campaigns (ex. Testimonials of participants)
- Free trial/demo of service for initial reach

Resources: Social Media coordinators, Free trial design and implementation

90 Days

Strengthen Revenue and Loyal Customer Base

Aim for Long-term Growth:

- Convert pilot users into paying customers
- Optimize and automate menial stages of customer registration
- Evaluate contracts and target long-term, high value partnerships

Implementation Considerations

- Risks & assumptions - Some things to keep in mind:
  - That students and parents are willing to pay for external AI guidance.
  - Social media outreach could simmer down if engagement is low.
  - Just because communication on the platform is optimized, it does not exactly translate to higher conversion rates.
  - Brand confusion if the platform is not unique enough.

- Success metrics:
  - Engagement and increase in registration during the 90-day user testing period.
  - Users are satisfied to the point where conversion rate from free trial to paid service.
  - Social media engagement sees continued growth.
  - A good amount of positive feedback collected.

Expected Impact & Value

- Short-term benefits
  - Helps customer understand why the service can help them
  - Increases student engagement
- Long-term strategic value
  - EdVisingU becomes a well-known learning platform in the technology industry
  - Creates an opportunity for partnerships
- Business impact summary
  - Strengthening branding gives EdVisingU a competitive advantage and growth. In the short term, customers will be able to understand the programs' formatting and goals of the company. Students will be more likely to enroll when they have a strong understanding of what the company can do for them, knowing that modern technology is part of the jobs of the future. More sign ups turns into more revenue and customer base. In the long run, creating a reputable brand creates potential partnerships with schools or technology companies. Clarity in marketing will improve customer trust, revenue growth and long-term success for EdVisingU

Key Takeaways

- Clear branding helps students understand that EdVisingU values the student learning experience, making students more likely to enroll
- Strong communication builds trust between the customer and the company. There are many available courses, but EdVisingU can stand out by clarifying its brand message
- Aligns with the company's goals of boosting education and career growth. Over time, EdvisingU can build a strong reputation that will attract partnerships

Final Recommendation: Heighten Customer Attraction and Retention through Target Consumer Promotions and Service Implementations like free trials and demos

Appendix - Parental Role in Postsecondary Success

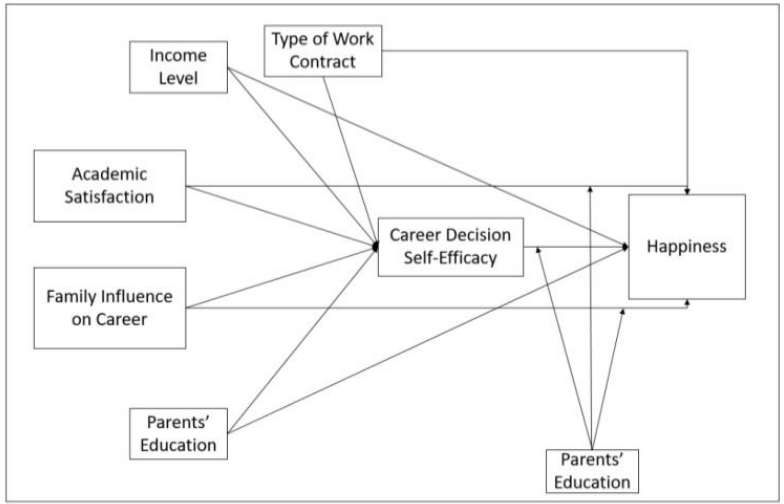
Parents and policies can drive postsecondary success

Despite these challenges, research suggests that parental involvement can have a positive impact on students' college-planning process and decisions. Even if parents do not feel confident about their knowledge about the application process, their interest in and support for their child's college planning and application can positively affect their child's postsecondary success. For example, in one study, first-generation college students were more likely than other college students to report that they went to college because of their parents' encouragement, even if their parents lacked helpful knowledge of the application process.[4]

Additionally, numerous policies and interventions exist to make college more affordable and feasible, particularly for low-income and first-generation college students. Several communities across the country have implemented "promise" programs, which offer free tuition to local two- or four-year institutions, and these communities have experienced increased rates of high school graduation and college enrollment and graduation. Other interventions that offer information and advising services to guide students through the college admissions and enrollment process have had positive impacts on postsecondary outcomes as well.[2] Identifying and sharing information about programs and policies to promote postsecondary education in the REL AP region could help to address some of the barriers families face.

Source: Institute of Education Sciences

Appendix - The Role of Family Influence and Academic Satisfaction on Career Decision-Making Self-Efficacy and Happiness



Source: National Library of Medicine

Appendix - 90% Of College Students Use AI: Higher Ed Needs AI Fluency Support Now

What's Next For Higher Education

For colleges, the message is clear. If students are already using AI universally, institutions that continue to treat it as a fringe issue risk irrelevance. "Rarely does a technology become so essential that every student and worker must understand it," notes Dimitris Bertsimas, Vice Provost of MIT's Open Learning and Associate Dean of Online Education & Artificial Intelligence at MIT Sloan.

College assignments that assume "no AI" increasingly feel outdated. Students with informal AI skills are forging ahead with little to no guidance on responsible use. The vast majority of professionals surveyed in a SHRM survey, 83%, believe that AI is foundational to workforce preparedness. Given employer attitudes and a $1.1 trillion annual skills gap, universities that ignore AI risk reputational harm as well as workforce misalignment.

Source: Forbes

Appendix - 59% of young people believe AI poses a threat to their job prospects, according to a new Harvard Youth Poll



The Harvard Youth Poll also found that 52% of people ages 18-29 trust AI to help them complete school or work assignments. Scott Olson/Getty Images

Dec 4, 2025, 11:06 AM ET Share Save

- Young people are pessimistic about the impact AI will have on their job prospects, per a new poll.
- 59% of Americans surveyed between 18 and 29 believe AI poses a threat to their job prospects, a new Harvard Youth Poll says.
- The poll also found that 52% of young people trust AI to help them complete assignments.

Source: Business Insider

Appendix - The Government of Canada announces over $2.8M in AI to advance economic growth and digital literacy

The Government of Canada announces over $2.8M in AI to advance economic growth and digital literacy

From: Canadian Northern Economic Development Agency

Backgrounder

February 6, 2026 – Yellowknife, Northwest Territories – Canadian Northern Economic Development Agency (CanNor)

This information adds to the news release issued on February 6 Minister Chartrand announces over $2.8M in AI to advance economic growth and digital literacy outlining CanNor's support, the businesses and organizations that received funding, and their projects.

The Government of Canada, through CanNor, is providing $2,815,999 in funding for four projects that support digital literacy and AI adoption in communities across Nunavut, the Northwest Territories and the Yukon.

Project information

Project: AI Driven Entrepreneurship and Business Support Centre
Recipient: Prosper NWT
Location: Northwest Territories

Source: Government of Canada